

Inclusive Classroom Management Plan

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Philosophy: The Classroom as a Team

My approach to classroom management is centered on the concept of "Teamwork." I believe that a classroom functions best when every student feels like a valued member of a cohesive unit. By framing our classroom community as a "team," I foster an environment where students learn to support one another, practice kindness, and work toward shared goals.

Building Relationships and Community

Building a positive culture starts with encouraging students to work together and emphasizing the importance of mutual support.

- **Team Player of the Week:** At the start of each week, I select a "Team Player" who has demonstrated exceptional collaboration or kindness. This student is recognized with special classroom privileges for the week.
- **Kindness as a Core Trait:** I explicitly teach and hold students responsible for treating one another with kindness, framing it as a vital life skill they will carry far beyond the classroom.
- **Impact:** These strategies contribute to a caring community where every student is treated respectfully by both their peers and the teacher.

Structure and Setting Expectations

A safe and inclusive learning environment is maintained through clear expectations and student-led norms.

- **Collaborative Class Rules:** We begin by discussing various types of successful teams (sports, debate, dance). Students then brainstorm what it means to be a "good teammate," and their ideas are written on a poster to become our official "Class Rules".

- **Table Group Responsibilities:** Each member of a table group is assigned a specific role to ensure the school day regulates smoothly. Table groups earn points for performing their jobs efficiently and quietly.
- **Rationale:** These strategies work because students have a clear understanding of what is expected and a collective goal they are striving to reach as a team.

Instructional Engagement

Engagement is the cornerstone of effective classroom management. When students are excited to learn, they are naturally more focused and productive.

- **Real-World Relevance:** I relate content to students' everyday lives as much as possible, ensuring the curriculum feels impactful and interesting.
- **Collaborative Strategies:** Lessons incorporate ample time for students to discuss their thoughts and gain new perspectives. I utilize Universal Design for Learning (UDL) strategies such as:
 - Think-Pair-Share
 - Small group and table discussions

Supporting Challenging Behaviors

I do not believe there are "troublemakers"—only teammates who need extra support or guidance.

- **Connection and Respect:** I make a point to know students with challenging behaviors deeply, connecting with them over their interests to build mutual respect.
- **Individualized Incentives:** I incentivize work by offering students time to engage in activities they enjoy once they meet their specific goals.
- **Holistic Support:** Understanding a student's life outside of school allows me to better support them if they are facing external challenges that may hinder their behavior in the classroom.
- **Growth Mindset:** By showing students they are valued for their unique traits, I foster a sense of belonging and importance within the team.